AfriEnergy Insights — April 8, 2026

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AfriEnergy Insights

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The African Energy Intelligence Briefing for Investors, Policy Advisors & Development Finance Practitioners

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1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The AfriEnergy Tracker now monitors **284 projects across 43 countries**, representing **$141.6B in total tracked investment** across nine sectors. This edition's reporting period (last 7 days) saw **1 new project added** to the database — a relatively quiet week for new entries, though external intelligence signals continued deal activity across Senegal, Ivory Coast, Equatorial Guinea, and Egypt.

The **Grid Expansion** sector remains one of the most undercapitalised relative to its strategic importance: just **10 projects totalling $3.8B** are tracked, against a solar pipeline of 181 projects and $36.3B. This edition's Sector Spotlight examines why transmission and distribution infrastructure continues to lag generation investment, and what the current project pipeline reveals about emerging financing models.

Morocco commands attention as this edition's Country in Focus. The Kingdom has assembled a dense cluster of **12 tracked projects** — spanning commissioned flagship assets, active construction, announced solar programmes, and a broad World Bank policy financing programme — that collectively position it as North Africa's most institutionally backed energy transition market.

Externally, this week's most significant headline is Chevron's **$690M final investment decision** for the Aseng Gas Project in Equatorial Guinea, alongside Eni's reported **2 trillion cubic feet (tcf) gas discovery** offshore Egypt — both signalling continued upstream momentum in African hydrocarbons even as the renewable pipeline expands.

Data limitation note: The AfriEnergy Tracker covers 284 projects as of this edition. The database does not claim to be exhaustive of all African energy activity; material transactions may exist outside its current scope.

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2. MARKET OVERVIEW

AfriEnergy Tracker Snapshot — 8 April 2026

Metric	Value
Total Tracked Projects	284
Total Tracked Investment	$141.6B
Countries Covered	43
Sectors Tracked	9
Projects Added (Last 7 Days)	1

Regional Distribution

Region	Projects	Investment
East Africa	90	$31.6B
North Africa	45	$34.1B
Southern Africa	48	$19.7B
West Africa	69	$27.3B
Central Africa	28	$27.9B

East Africa leads by project count with **90 projects**, while North Africa commands the highest average deal size — **$34.1B across 45 projects**, approximately $758M per project on average — reflecting large-scale infrastructure and integrated energy programmes in markets such as Morocco and Egypt. Central Africa's **28 projects at $27.9B** similarly reflects the capital intensity of the region's large hydropower assets.

Sectoral Distribution

Sector	Projects	Investment
Solar	181	$36.3B
Oil & Gas	29	$60.0B
Hydro	25	$27.0B
Hydrogen	1	$4.6B
Grid Expansion	10	$3.8B
Wind	23	$3.6B
Bioenergy	7	$3.6B
Coal	2	$2.6B
Battery & Storage	6	$0.1B

The data illustrates a persistent structural pattern: **Oil & Gas commands $60.0B across just 29 projects** — the highest average ticket size in the tracker at approximately $2.1B per project — while **Battery & Storage registers just $0.1B across 6 projects**, the lowest aggregate investment of any sector with tracked financing. Solar dominates by project count (181 projects, 63.7% of the total) but represents only $36.3B, underscoring the prevalence of smaller-scale and distributed solar transactions.

Data note: Geothermal, Nuclear, and Clean Cooking register zero projects in the current tracker. This likely reflects data collection gaps or pipeline immaturity rather than an absence of activity in these sectors continent-wide.

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3. SECTOR SPOTLIGHT: Grid Expansion

10 Projects | $3.8B Tracked Investment

The AfriEnergy Tracker's Grid Expansion portfolio is the smallest by project count in the database — and among the most analytically revealing. With **10 projects and $3.8B in tracked investment**, grid infrastructure accounts for just **2.7% of total tracked investment**, despite being the enabling layer upon which every generation asset in the database ultimately depends. The data suggests a structural financing gap between the ambitions of Africa's generation pipeline and the transmission and distribution networks required to deliver that power to end users.

Data limitation note: Investment sizes are not disclosed for 6 of the 10 tracked Grid Expansion projects. Deal values where available are noted below. Capacity figures are not available for any of the 10 projects.

Project-by-Project Analysis

Nigeria is the most active country in the Grid Expansion pipeline by tracked financing value. Two entries — the **AfDB Nigeria Economic Governance and Energy Transition Loan** ($500M, 2025) and the **Nigeria AfDB $500 Million Energy Transition Loan** ($500M, 2025) — both credit the **African Development Bank (AfDB)** as investor. The tracker records these as distinct entries; practitioners should note the possibility that these represent overlapping or related facilities under the same AfDB programme, and due diligence on deduplication is warranted. A third Nigeria-linked entry — the **AfDB $100 Million Loan to EAAIF for Sustainable**

Infrastructure ($100M, 2025) — channels financing through the **Emerging Africa & Asia Infrastructure Fund (EAAIF)**, a blended finance vehicle, adding a further $100M to Nigeria's grid-adjacent pipeline.

Combined, Nigeria's three AfDB-linked Grid Expansion entries represent up to **$1.1B in tracked financing** — the majority of the sector's disclosed investment value.

Kenya presents one of the most instructive case studies in the tracker. The **Kenya Adani Energy Deal Cancellation** ($2.5B, 2024) records the collapse of what would have been the single largest Grid Expansion transaction in the database, with **Adani Group** as the named investor. The tracker records this as a cancellation event — a critical data point for risk assessment. In its wake, the **Kenya PPP Transmission Lines Programme (Post-Adani)** was announced in 2025, though no deal size or investors are disclosed. The sequencing of these two entries illustrates a broader pattern: when large-scale private transmission deals fail, governments typically pivot toward public-private partnership structures, though financing terms and timelines remain uncertain.

The $2.5B Adani deal's cancellation represents a significant setback for Kenya's grid modernisation ambitions. The replacement PPP programme — still at the **Announced** stage with no financial details disclosed — means Kenya's transmission gap remains substantially unfilled within the current tracker data.

Mozambique features the **Gridworks Independent Transmission Project (ITP)**, with **DFC (US Development Finance Corporation)** and **Gridworks** named as investors. No deal size is disclosed. This project is noteworthy as a rare example of a **privately developed and financed independent transmission project** on the continent — a model that development finance institutions have been advocating for but which remains structurally rare. Gridworks, a UK-based infrastructure investor specialising in African electricity networks, brings sector-specific expertise that distinguishes this from standard DFI loan facilities.

Zambia's Rural Energy Projects 2026 (149 Grid and Off-Grid) is the only project in the portfolio at the **Announced** stage with no investor or deal size disclosed. Its scope — 149 grid and off-grid subprojects — suggests a programmatic, government-led initiative rather than a single private transaction.

Sudan's Power Sector Rehabilitation ($230M, 2022) carries the oldest vintage in the portfolio, with **World Bank, IsDB, and AfDB** as co-financiers. Given Sudan's ongoing political and security crisis, the current implementation status of this project cannot be confirmed from tracker data alone.

Ethiopia and **South Africa** each contribute one entry — the **EKA Mobility Electric Vehicle Expansion East Africa** and the **Kiira Motors 450-Bus Electric Fleet Deal** respectively — which are classified under Grid Expansion in the tracker but relate primarily to electric mobility rather than transmission or distribution infrastructure. No financial details are disclosed for either.

Structural Observation

The data suggests that Grid Expansion financing on the continent remains heavily dependent on **multilateral development banks** — AfDB appears in at least three of the ten entries as a primary financier. Private capital, where it appears (Adani Group, Gridworks/DFC), has either failed to reach execution or remains at early stages. The **Battery & Storage sector's $0.1B across 6 projects** compounds this picture: without storage and without grid, the continent's 181 solar projects face structural constraints on impact delivery.

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4. COUNTRY IN FOCUS: Morocco

12 Tracked Projects | North Africa's Most Institutionally Backed Energy Market

Morocco's energy portfolio in the AfriEnergy Tracker spans **12 projects** and represents one of the most diversified financing structures of any single-country dataset in the database. The projects range from a **commissioned wind asset dating to 2012** through to **2026 announced and financial close stage transactions**, providing a rare longitudinal view of an African energy market's evolution.

Data limitation note: Investment sizes are disclosed for 7 of the 12 projects. Capacity figures are not available for most entries. Sector classifications for several non-solar projects (e.g., EV assembly, pumped hydro) are recorded as "Solar" in the tracker, which may reflect a classification limitation rather than the underlying project nature.

The World Bank as Morocco's Anchor Financier

The World Bank appears as investor across **five of the twelve tracked projects**, with disclosed commitments totalling **$1.47B**:

- **Morocco Jobs and Green Growth Development Policy Operation** — $500M (2026)
- **Morocco Climate & Risk Finance Program** — $300M (2026)
- **Morocco Digital Acceleration Program** — $250M (2026)
- **Morocco Ifahsa Pumped Hydropower Storage (PHS) Project** — $220M (2026)
- **Morocco Disaster and Climate Resilience Program** — $200M (2025)

The clustering of four World Bank commitments in 2026 alone is notable. The **Jobs and Green Growth Development Policy Operation** — at $500M the largest single disclosed commitment — is described as the "1st of the programmatic series," signalling that additional tranches are anticipated. The **Ifahsa Pumped Hydropower Storage project** is particularly strategically significant: pumped hydro is one of the few long-duration storage technologies available at scale, and its presence in the Moroccan pipeline addresses a critical gap that pure solar or wind capacity cannot fill.

Generation Assets: Commissioned and Pipeline

The **Ouarzazate Solar Complex (NOOR)** ($2.4B, commissioned 2012) remains the anchor asset in Morocco's tracked portfolio — and at $2.4B, the largest single investment in the country's dataset. Financed by a consortium including the **World Bank, AfDB, European Investment Bank (EIB), KfW, and the Climate Investment Funds (CIF)**, NOOR represents the archetypal multilateral co-financing structure for flagship African renewable assets. Its commissioned status makes it one of the few projects in the tracker that can be assessed for delivery rather than pipeline intent.

The **Tarfaya Wind Farm** ($850M, commissioned 2012) — financed by **Nareva, GDF Suez, and IFC** — demonstrates Morocco's early integration of private developers alongside development finance. At $850M, it remains the only wind asset in Morocco's tracker portfolio.

Looking forward, **ACWA Power Morocco Solar Projects (2 x 400 MW)** (Announced, 2025) represents a combined 800 MW of potential new solar capacity, though no investment size is disclosed. ACWA Power's presence as developer signals continued interest from Gulf-based IPPs in Morocco's renewable market. The **Masen Solar Power Programme** reached **Financial Close in 2026**, with **Bank of Africa** named as financier — a notable example of domestic commercial bank participation in renewable project finance, with **MASEN (Moroccan Agency for Sustainable Energy)** as developer. The **Noor Atlas Solar Programme** (2026) is also tracked, though no financial details or investors are disclosed.

Industrial and EV Sector Integration

The **Stellantis EV Assembly Hub Morocco** ($330M, under construction since 2023) — financed by **Stellantis, the Government of Morocco, and the European Investment Bank** — reflects Morocco's broader industrial strategy of positioning itself as an EV and battery supply chain hub for European markets. The project's inclusion in the energy tracker underscores the blurring boundary between energy transition investment and industrial policy.

Morocco's Positioning

Across the 12 tracked projects, Morocco demonstrates several characteristics that distinguish it within the AfriEnergy dataset: consistent multilateral financing relationships (particularly with the World Bank and EIB), the presence of both sovereign development policy lending and project-level private finance, active state-owned energy developer participation (MASEN), and early engagement with storage technology (Ifahsa PHS). The data does not allow for a comprehensive calculation of Morocco's total tracked investment given several undisclosed deal sizes, but disclosed values alone approach **$5.1B**, placing it among the most heavily capitalised single-country portfolios in the North Africa region.

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5. DEAL PIPELINE UPDATE

New Entries This Week: 1 Project

The AfriEnergy Tracker recorded **1 new project addition in the last 7 days**. The tracker does not specify which project was newly added in this reporting period; practitioners should consult the full tracker for the specific new entry.

Pipeline Stage Distribution (Grid Expansion Sector)

Of the 10 Grid Expansion projects with available stage data:

- **Announced**: 2 projects (Zambia Rural Energy Projects 2026; Kenya PPP Transmission Lines Programme)
- **Stage not disclosed**: 8 projects

No Grid Expansion projects are recorded at Construction, Financial Close, or Commissioned stage in the current tracker — a data point that underscores the early-stage nature of most transmission pipeline activity.

External Deal Activity This Week

According to **Energy Capital Power** (published 6 April 2026), a **€72M financing package** has been secured for Senegal's **NEA Kolda** project — a 60 MW solar and 72 MWh battery installation described as designed to strengthen grid reliability and diversify Senegal's energy mix. This project does not currently appear in the AfriEnergy Tracker and may represent a candidate for future database inclusion.

According to **Energy Capital Power** (published 7 April 2026), **Amethis** has acquired **ADEMAT** in Ivory Coast, as the country reportedly seeks **$1.9B in private power investment**. The acquisition is described as positioning ADEMAT to scale energy solutions regionally across West Africa.

According to **Energy Capital Power** (published 8 April 2026), **Chevron** has approved a **$690M final investment decision (FID)** for the **Aseng Gas Project** in Equatorial Guinea, advancing offshore Block I

development and expanding LNG output.

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6. INVESTMENT & FINANCING TRENDS

Multilateral Development Banks Dominate Disclosed Financing

Across the Grid Expansion and Morocco portfolios examined in this edition, **multilateral development banks (MDBs)** — led by the African Development Bank and World Bank — appear as the most frequently named financing parties. The AfDB is named in at least 3 of 10 Grid Expansion entries; the World Bank appears in 5 of 12 Morocco entries. This pattern is consistent with the broader expectation that grid and enabling infrastructure, given its public-good characteristics and lower commercial returns, attracts concessional and quasi-concessional capital rather than pure private equity or commercial debt.

Battery & Storage: The Capital Gap

The tracker records **6 Battery & Storage projects at $0.1B total** — the lowest aggregate investment of any tracked sector. This stands in stark contrast to the scale of the solar pipeline ($36.3B, 181 projects). The data suggests that storage financing has not kept pace with generation investment, which has direct implications for the deliverability of solar capacity across the continent.

Private Capital: Selective and Risk-Sensitive

Where private capital does appear in the Grid Expansion tracker, the outcomes are mixed. The Adani Group's $2.5B Kenya deal — which would have been the sector's largest transaction — resulted in cancellation. Gridworks and DFC's Mozambique ITP remains at an undisclosed early stage. The data suggests private transmission investment faces significant execution risk, and that deal structures, regulatory frameworks, and political risk management will be decisive factors in converting announced intentions into commissioned assets.

Blended Finance as a Bridge

The appearance of **EAAIF** (Emerging Africa & Asia Infrastructure Fund) in the Nigeria grid entry, and the **CIF** (Climate Investment Funds) in Morocco's Ouarzazate complex, illustrates the role of blended finance vehicles in de-risking transactions that would not otherwise attract commercial capital at acceptable terms. This structure remains a key feature of African energy project finance architecture.

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7. GLOBAL CONTEXT & EXTERNAL INTELLIGENCE

This section draws exclusively on the External Intelligence items provided from RSS feeds published during the reporting period. All items sourced from Energy Capital Power.

Upstream Oil & Gas: Two Major Developments

According to **Energy Capital Power** (published 8 April 2026), **Eni** has announced a new gas discovery offshore Egypt with estimated reserves of approximately **2 trillion cubic feet (tcf) of natural gas** and **130 million barrels of associated condensates**. The report notes the discovery comes as Egypt seeks to close a domestic

supply gap. This represents a potentially significant reserve addition for Egypt's gas sector and could reshape the country's LNG export positioning.

According to **Energy Capital Power** (published 8 April 2026), **Chevron** has approved a **$690M FID** for the **Aseng Gas Project** in Equatorial Guinea, advancing offshore Block I development and expanding LNG output and regional gas infrastructure. An FID at this scale signals sustained investor confidence in Equatorial Guinea's upstream gas sector despite the global energy transition narrative.

West Africa: Private Investment and Infrastructure

According to **Energy Capital Power** (published 6 April 2026), a **€72M financing package** has been secured for Senegal's **NEA Kolda** project — a 60 MW solar and 72 MWh battery installation — described as designed to strengthen grid reliability and advance Senegal's universal electricity access goals. The co-location of solar generation and battery storage in a single project is consistent with the integrated approach increasingly required in markets with weak grid infrastructure.

According to **Energy Capital Power** (published 8 April 2026), Senegal is also expanding port infrastructure, industrial zones, and rural electrification as exports and oil production surge, reflecting the country's broader infrastructure push to keep pace with rising trade activity.

According to **Energy Capital Power** (published 7 April 2026), **Amethis** has acquired **ADEMAT** as Ivory Coast pursues **$1.9B in private power investment** to meet universal electricity access targets. The deal is described as positioning ADEMAT for regional scale-up across West Africa.

Critical Minerals: Kenya, Zambia, Guinea

According to **Energy Capital Power** (published 8 April 2026), **Kenya** has launched investor access to strategic minerals across five counties, aiming to shift its mining sector toward critical resources. According to **Energy Capital Power** (published 6 April 2026), **Zambia's Molefe copper expansion** — led by Jubilee Metals — highlights Zambia's mine-to-processing integration model and its ambitions in global critical mineral supply chains. According to **Energy Capital Power** (published 7 April 2026), **Guinea-Conakry** and **Resolute** have struck a partnership to fast-track gold exploration and development.

Mining Automation

According to **Energy Capital Power** (published 6 April 2026), mining automation across **South Africa, Mali, and the DRC** is advancing safety and efficiency through autonomous drilling and haulage systems, with implications for energy demand profiles at mine sites — a topic of growing relevance for off-grid and embedded generation project developers.

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8. RISK RADAR

1. Grid Cancellation Risk — Kenya Precedent The **$2.5B Kenya Adani Energy Deal Cancellation** in the tracker is the single most consequential negative event recorded in the Grid Expansion portfolio. Its scale — equivalent to 65.8% of the entire tracked Grid Expansion investment pool — illustrates that even very large announced transactions in this sector carry significant execution risk. The replacement **Kenya PPP Transmission**

Lines Programme carries no disclosed financing, underscoring the risk that cancellation creates multi-year pipeline voids.

2. Data Transparency and Disclosure Risk Six of ten Grid Expansion projects have no disclosed deal size. Seven of twelve Morocco projects have no disclosed capacity figure. This level of non-disclosure limits analytical confidence and investor due diligence. The AfriEnergy Tracker reflects the broader African energy data environment, where project information is often incomplete, delayed, or unavailable from public sources.

3. Conflict and Political Risk — Sudan The **Sudan Power Sector Rehabilitation** ($230M, 2022) was co-financed by the World Bank, IsDB, and AfDB. Given Sudan's documented political and security deterioration since 2022, the implementation status and disbursement profile of this project are uncertain. Practitioners should treat this project as materially at risk.

4. Sector Concentration Risk The tracker records **181 solar projects at $36.3B** — 63.7% of all tracked projects concentrated in a single technology. While solar is appropriate for many African market conditions, this concentration means that sector-specific risks (panel supply chain disruptions, grid integration constraints, curtailment) could affect a disproportionately large share of the tracked portfolio.

5. Storage Underinvestment Risk The **$0.1B Battery & Storage pipeline** across 6 projects represents a systemic bottleneck risk. Without co-located or grid-scale storage, large volumes of solar generation cannot be reliably dispatched — limiting the real-world energy access impact of the dominant solar pipeline.

6. Upstream Carbon Lock-In Risk The Oil & Gas sector accounts for **$60.0B across 29 projects** — 42.4% of total tracked investment. Chevron's $690M Aseng FID and Eni's Egypt discovery (both reported this week) signal continued upstream commitment. While African nations have legitimate energy access and development finance needs, the scale of hydrocarbon investment relative to grid and storage infrastructure raises long-term transition risk questions for DFI-exposed portfolios.

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9. KEY TAKEAWAYS & OUTLOOK

1. The Grid Gap Is the Defining Constraint The AfriEnergy Tracker's 181 solar projects at $36.3B exist within a grid infrastructure context of just 10 projects at $3.8B. The data does not allow for a precise estimate of the delivery gap, but the ratio — approximately 9.5x more tracked solar investment than grid investment — suggests that transmission and distribution must attract substantially more capital to convert Africa's generation pipeline into delivered electricity.

2. Morocco Is Demonstrating a Replicable Model Morocco's 12-project dataset combines commissioned flagship assets, active World Bank policy lending, domestic bank participation (Bank of Africa in the Masen programme), Gulf IPP engagement (ACWA Power), and European industrial investment (Stellantis/EIB). The Ifahsa Pumped Hydro Storage project adds a storage dimension rarely seen at this stage in African market portfolios. The data suggests Morocco is operating a more institutionally mature energy investment ecosystem than most comparable African markets.

3. MDB Dominance Signals a Private Capital Gap in Grid Across this edition's Sector Spotlight and Country in Focus, multilateral institutions dominate disclosed financing. This is not inherently negative — MDB capital is catalytic — but it does indicate that grid infrastructure has not yet achieved the risk-adjusted return profile required

to attract significant private capital at scale, with the Adani cancellation and Gridworks/DFC project's early stage reinforcing this reading.

4. West Africa's Week: Senegal and Ivory Coast Signal Momentum According to Energy Capital Power, the €72M NEA Kolda solar-plus-storage deal in Senegal and the Amethis/ADEMAT acquisition in Ivory Coast (with $1.9B in private power investment reportedly being sought) represent meaningful pipeline signals for West Africa — a region with 69 tracked projects and $27.3B in the database. Practitioners with West Africa exposure should monitor whether these transactions translate into tracker-eligible project entries in coming weeks.

5. Upstream Gas Is Not Retreating Chevron's $690M Aseng FID and Eni's 2 tcf Egypt discovery — both reported in the last 48 hours of this edition's reporting period — confirm that upstream hydrocarbon investment retains significant momentum in African markets. The Oil & Gas sector's $60.0B pipeline in the tracker is not a historical artifact; it reflects active and ongoing capital deployment.

6. Watch for Battery & Storage Catalysts At $0.1B across 6 projects, Battery & Storage is the tracker's most underdeveloped sector by disclosed investment. The NEA Kolda project's 72 MWh battery component — even though not yet in the tracker — is a data point consistent with a broader market shift toward integrated solar-storage solutions. Practitioners should monitor whether this trend begins to populate the tracker's storage pipeline in coming editions.

AfriEnergy Insights is published periodically by the AfriEnergy Intelligence team. All data is drawn from the AfriEnergy Tracker (284 projects as of 8 April 2026) and attributed external sources. Investment figures represent tracked commitments and do not constitute a comprehensive survey of African energy finance. Data limitations are disclosed throughout. Nothing in this publication constitutes investment advice.

Next edition: Sector Spotlight and Country in Focus to be confirmed. Submit data corrections and project submissions to the AfriEnergy Tracker team.

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⚠️ AI-generated analysis based on AfriEnergy Tracker database. Verify critical figures against primary sources.